

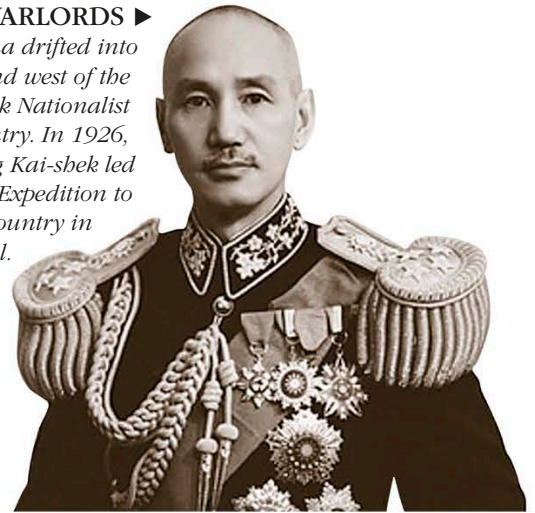
CHILD IN TIME

Puyi became the last emperor of China at the age of two in 1908, but was then overthrown in the Xinhai Revolution. He was made a puppet emperor of Manchuria by the Japanese in 1934, without any real power. After their defeat in 1945, Puyi was imprisoned. He died in 1967.



NATIONALISTS AND WARLORDS ►

After the revolution of 1911, China drifted into chaos, with much of the north and west of the country ruled by rival warlords. A weak Nationalist government ruled the south of the country. In 1926, the Nationalist military leader Chiang Kai-shek led a campaign known as the Northern Expedition to fight the warlords and reunified the country in 1928 under his control.

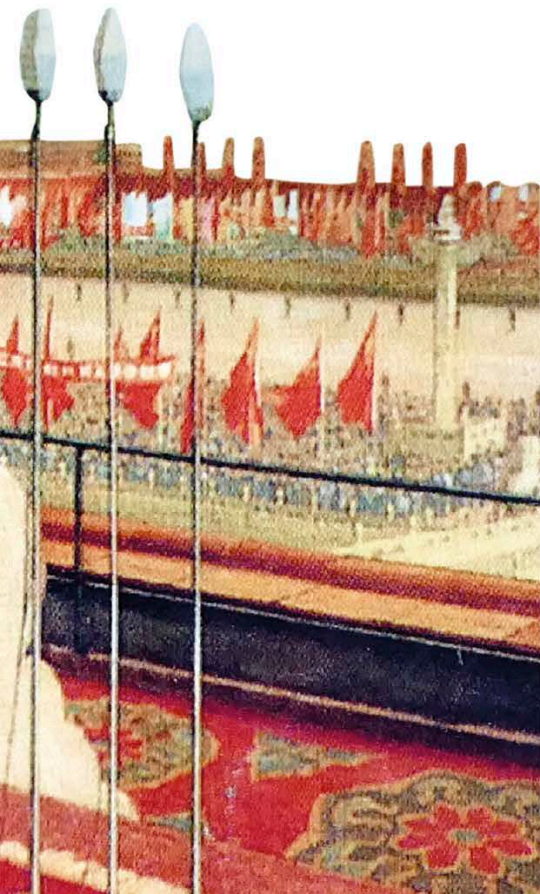


Smoke rises from buildings after the Japanese bombing of Shanghai.



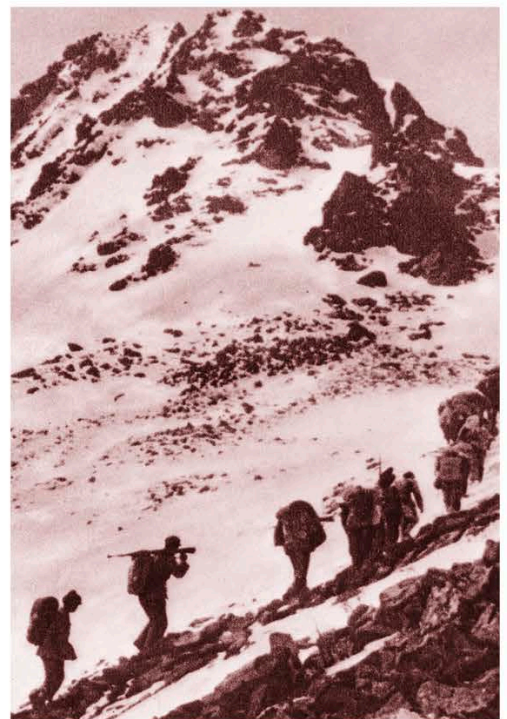
WAR AGAINST JAPAN ►

In 1931, the Japanese seized the northern province of Manchuria. They then launched a full-scale invasion of China in 1937, capturing most of the northeast and the east coast, including Shanghai. The Chinese fought back, helped by the US and the Soviet Union, and the war ended with Japan's surrender in 1945.



CIVIL WAR ►

The Chinese Communist Party (CCP) was formed in Shanghai in 1921, and helped the Nationalist government defeat the warlords, but in 1927 the Nationalists turned on their Communist allies. In 1934, Communist forces retreated to the north—a 12-month expedition known as the Long March (right)—to avoid capture. A truce was agreed between the two sides in 1937, but war broke out again in 1946.



◀ COMMUNIST CHINA

By 1949, Communist forces had captured much of China from the Nationalists. On October 1, CCP leader Mao Zedong founded the new People's Republic of China, setting up a Communist government in the most populous state in the world.